Be Angry, and Sin Not

Ephesians 4:25-32 (KJV)

Scripture

Ephesians 4:25-32

[25] Wherefore putting away lying, speak every man truth with his neighbour: for we are members one of another. [26] Be ye angry, and sin not: let not the sun go down upon your wrath: [27] Neither give place to the devil. [28] Let him that stole steal no more: but rather let him labour, working with his hands the thing which is good, that he may have to give to him that needeth. [29] Let no corrupt communication proceed out of your mouth, but that which is good to the use of edifying, that it may minister grace unto the hearers. [30] And grieve not the holy Spirit of God, whereby ye are sealed unto the day of redemption. [31] Let all bitterness, and wrath, and anger, and clamour, and evil speaking, be put away from you, with all malice: [32] And be ye kind one to another, tenderhearted, forgiving one another, even as God for Christ's sake hath forgiven you.

Outline

1. Anger must be handled quickly

Be ye angry, and _____ not.

Let not the _____ go down upon your wrath.

Read: Ephesians 4:26-27; Mark 3:5; James 1:19-20

2. Put away bitterness and harmful words

Let no _____ communication proceed out of your mouth.

Grieve not the holy _____ of God.

Read: Ephesians 4:29-31; Proverbs 15:1; Colossians 3:8

3. Replace it with kindness and forgiveness

Be ye kind one to another, _____, forgiving one another.

Forgive even as God for Christ's sake hath _____ you.

Read: Ephesians 4:32; Colossians 3:12-13; Matthew 6:14-15

Discussion questions

1. What is the difference between righteous anger and sinful anger?

2. Why do you think Paul says not to let the sun go down on our anger?

3. Which item in verse 31 is the hardest for you to put away?

4. How does remembering God's forgiveness help us forgive others?

This week

If you are carrying anger toward someone, settle it before the sun goes down: pray about it today, and take one step toward peace if it is safe and wise. Before you speak in a tense moment this week, ask: "Will this build up, or tear down?"